

Accounting and Finance

WACE written examination—2010 design brief

Stage 3

Time allowed

Reading time before commencing work: ten minutes

Working time for paper: three hours

Permissible items

Standard items: pens, pencils, eraser, correction fluid, ruler, highlighter

Special items: non-programmable calculator

Additional Information

The examination content comprises 40–60% Unit 3A and 40–60% Unit 3B.

The balance of theory/practical (application) in the exam is theory 30–35% and practical (application) 65–70%.

The weightings of the content areas are within the following ranges:

Financial institutions and systems	10–15%
Recording, using and evaluating financial information	70–80%
Government and the community	10–15%

The examination will be presented in a combined question/answer booklet with a separate multiple-choice answer sheet.

Candidates are provided with a specifications booklet identical to that on the curriculum council website. This booklet includes formulae/tables and relevant information related to the standards and legislation.

Section	Supporting information
Section One Multiple-choice 5–10% of the written exam 10–20 questions Suggested working time: 15–25 minutes	Candidates indicate their answers on the separate multiple-choice answer sheet. Stimulus material may be used and could include calculations, short excerpts from newspaper/journal articles, data interpretation and diagrams.
Section Two: Written 90–95% of the written exam 4–8 questions Suggested working time: 155–165 minutes	Questions in this section include applications, scenarios and case studies, as well as responses to text extracts. Questions are of a higher order requiring candidates to demonstrate an in-depth understanding of accounting and finance principles and concepts. Candidates are encouraged to demonstrate their understanding by analysing, applying, interpreting and evaluating information from the syllabus. Written answers may be supplemented with dot points, diagrams, tables etc. Suitable stimulus materials include extracts from financial journals and other articles on current issues involving accounting and finance. No limit to length of answer in Stage 3.